INTRODUCTION

India has travelled a long way since her Independence in 1947 and is gradually assuming the status of an ‘emerging power’. Despite several challenges from within her polity arising from her unique character as a sub-continental, multilingual entity, severely constraining her ability, India has managed to exhibit her prowess in terms of nuclear as well as military capabilities while exercising restraint whenever required.

India’s foreign policy has evolved over the years under the influence of the country’s geo-strategic location, economic conditions, political tradition, societal fabric, national character, national morale and personality traits of the leaders. If these constitute the internal factors shaping the Indian Foreign Policy, then international political environment, foreign policies of major powers and those of the neighbouring countries comprise the external determinants of Indian foreign policy. It must be noted here that Indian foreign policy has never been a static one and it has undergone changes due to the changing domestic as well as international scenario.